

MATH 10A — STRUCTURE AND CONCEPTS IN MATH I

Day 1

Welcome to Math 10A

How this class works

How to Reach Me

- **Instructor:** Mong Kon Mo
- **Office:** Science 2, Room 364
- **Email:** mongkonmo@csufresno.edu
Start the subject line with **[Math 10A Fall 2026]**.
- **Student Support Hours:** Monday and Wednesday 4:00–5:00 PM, Tuesday 1:00–2:30 PM, Thursday 9:00–10:30 AM
- **Appointments:** book a 25-minute slot in the FSM Portal, at least 4 hours ahead.

What This Course Is About

This course is built for future elementary school teachers. We take the arithmetic you already do and open it up: whole numbers, other bases, number theory, integers, fractions, decimals, percentages, real numbers, and patterns.

You will not just get answers. You will learn **why** each method works, so that one day you can explain it to a child.

This is a 3-unit course. Plan about 6 hours of work each week outside of class.

A Question About Grades

**You get 78% on a test.
What does that tell you
about what you can do?**

It does not tell you which parts you know and which parts you still need. So this class does not grade that way.

Your Work Gets a Mark, Not a Score

Mark	What it means
X	Not assessable. Nothing to grade. No reattempt.
N	New attempt needed. You are making progress.
R	May revise. Close, with small errors.
M	Meets expectations.
E	Exceeds expectations.

M or E means you are proficient. Once you earn it, it is yours. It never goes back down.

22 Learning Targets

A Learning Target is one skill, written so you know exactly what you must show me.

- Eighteen of them are assessed on a **Knowledge Check** in class.
- You earn a mark on each LT you attempt.
- Earn **M** or **E** once and that LT is done.
- Your final grade counts *how many* LTs you finished, not an average.

Missing an LT early in the semester is normal. You get more chances.

Four Knowledge Checks, All in Class

Knowledge Check	Date	Learning Targets
KC 1	Friday, September 18	LT.1 – LT.4
KC 2	Friday, October 9	LT.5 – LT.8 and LT.10
KC 3	Friday, October 30	LT.11 – LT.14
KC 4	Friday, November 20	LT.15 – LT.19

Bring a **scientific calculator**. A graphing calculator is not allowed, and neither is anything else.

You Get to Try Again

- Reattempts happen **in my office**. Book them in the FSM Portal.
- **No weekly limit**. Come back as often as you want. Up to **3 reattempts** on any one LT.
- Before you reattempt an LT from a Knowledge Check, finish that KC's **Reflection**.
- In **Week 9** and **Week 16** I hold an open **Reattempt Session**. No appointment. It does not use up one of your 3.

Each Knowledge Check also has a reattempt deadline. Those dates are in the syllabus and on Canvas.

Four LTs Work Differently

These four are not on a Knowledge Check. You earn them through your assignments.

LT	How you earn it
LT.9	Earn a passing mark on the GE ePortfolio assignment.
LT.20	Score 20 or more out of 25 on Practice 9.1 and Practice 9.2.
LT.21	Score 20 or more out of 25 on Practice 10.1, 10.2, and 10.3.
LT.22	Collect at least 1140 of the 1630 available PPP points.

Prep, Participation, and Practice

Type	When it is due	Points
Prep (MyOpenMath)	Before each class, by 11:59 PM the night before.	10
Participation (Exit Ticket)	At the end of class. The form closes 10 minutes after class ends.	10
Practice (MyOpenMath)	After each topic, by 11:59 PM the following Wednesday.	25

You get 5 attempts on a MyOpenMath question unless the question says otherwise, and then 100 fresh versions.

Metacognitive Assignments

About every two weeks I post a video or an article in Canvas. These are not about math concepts. They are about how you learn.

To pass one you must do both of these:

1. Write your own answer to the prompt, at a reasonable length.
2. Read and reply to at least **two** classmates, in a way that shows you actually read them.

There is no partial credit. You either did both, or you did not.

Three Projects to Choose From

1. **P.1 — Five Principles of Extraordinary Math Teaching**
2. **P.2 — Is This Prime?**
3. **P.3 — Fractions in the Wild**

You do not have to do all three. How many you do depends on the grade you are going for:

Grade you want	D	C	B	A
Projects you finish	0	1	2	3

The GE ePortfolio Assignment

This one is separate from the three Projects. It is an **Exploding Dots** exploration, built on our Chapter 3 work with other bases.

- It is how you earn **LT.9, Different Number Bases**.
- It counts for General Education Area 2.

Every grade of C or better needs this assignment, so put it on your calendar now.

How Your Final Grade Is Decided

You need	D	C	B	A
Learning Targets with M or E (of 22)	9	13	16	19
Metacognitive Assignments (of 5)	2	3	4	5
GE ePortfolio Assignment	0	1	1	1
Projects (of 3)	0	1	2	3
Attendance Days (of 43)	0	32	32	32
Recertification LTs (of 10)	1	3	4	5

You must meet **every row** in a column to earn that grade. You need a **C or better** to pass.

Where to See How You Are Doing

Your grade is a count, not an average. Canvas cannot add that up, so it will never show you a course grade.

- **FSM Portal → Grades.** Where you stand right now and what is still left for the grade you want. **Check it every week.**
- **Canvas.** The result of individual assignments.
- **My email after each Knowledge Check.** A copy of your work, my feedback, and a progress summary.

The FSM Portal is linked in the Canvas course menu.

Late Passes and Tokens

10 Late Passes. Each one moves a **Practice** due date one week later. Not for Prep. They do not stack, and none of them reach past the last day of the semester.

Up to 17 Tokens, earned three ways:

- **9 Tokens** for attendance, one at 1, 6, 11, 16, 21, 26, 31, 36, and 41 attendance days.
- **4 Tokens** for Knowledge Check Reflections, one per KC.
- **4 Tokens** for Extra Credit. Seven assignments are open, and Tokens come at 1, 3, 5, and 7 finished.

What One Token Buys

1. **An extension.** Move one Practice, Metacognitive, or Project to the end of the semester. This works even when a Late Pass no longer would.
2. **Another reattempt** on an LT you have already tried 3 times. You come take it in my office. **If you earn M or E, you get the Token back.**
3. **A challenge** on a mark you believe is wrong. Ask within one week of getting the result. **If you are right, you get the Token back.**

You spend Tokens in the FSM Portal, under Tokens in the sidebar.

Attendance

- Going to miss a class? Fill out the **Absence Report** form in the FSM Portal. That form is the only way an absence becomes excused.
- An unexcused absence lowers your Attendance Days by 1.
- **Two Lates count as one absence.** If you arrive after I take attendance, see me at the end of class.

Missing class for jury duty, military service, a school activity, or illness? Fill out the Absence Report form.

Devices, Recordings, and AI

- **Devices.** Phones, tablets, and laptops are for class work only. Misuse gets the whole class one warning. After that we stop using them.
- **Recordings.** I post the class recording, unless a quarter of the class is absent that day. After three such days, recordings stop for the semester.
- **AI tools.** Fine for brainstorming, summarizing, and getting an explanation. **Not** for producing your answers. You must be able to explain every part of what you hand in.

The Final Exam Is a Recertification

It covers **10 Learning Targets**. Earn E, M, or R on as many as you can. An E or M here counts exactly as it would on a Knowledge Check.

Bring one 8.5 by 11 inch sheet of **handwritten** notes and a scientific calculator.

Your section	Class time	Final exam
75905	MWF 8:00 AM	Wednesday, December 16, 8:45 – 10:45 AM
76061	MWF 9:00 AM	Monday, December 14, 8:45 – 10:45 AM